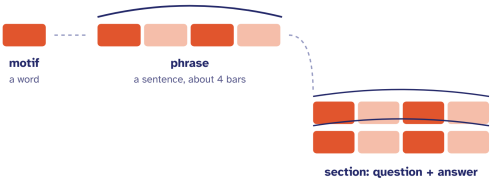
SHAPE AND STYLE · MOTIFS AND PHRASES · LEARN



Motifs and phrases

REMEMBER Most phrases are 4 bars. A question ends away from the home note; an answer comes home.

1 Question or answer?

★☆☆

Each phrase is in C major. Circle question or answer from its last note. The first is done.

ends on D	**question** · answer
ends on C	question · answer
ends on G	question · answer
ends on B	question · answer
ends on C	question · answer

2 Count the phrases
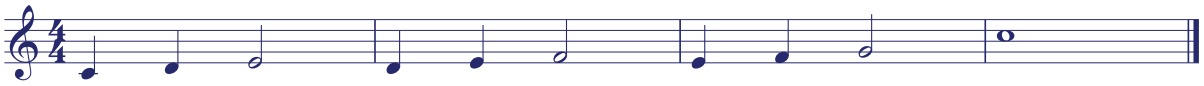
★☆☆

Each phrase is 4 bars long. Write how many phrases. The first is done.

TUNE	PHRASES
8 bars	2
12 bars	
16 bars	

3 Find the motif

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.



The motif has [3] notes.

It comes [ ] times.

Each time it starts one [ ] higher.

4 Play it

★☆☆

Sing Ode to Joy bars 1–4 and stop on the D (a question). Then sing the answer and land on C. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

SHAPE AND STYLE · MOTIFS AND PHRASES · USE

Motifs and phrases

REMEMBER A motif is short and comes back: listen for its rhythm and its shape.

1 Make a motif ★★☆

Move each motif up one step, then one step more. The first row is done.

MOTIF	ONE STEP UP	TWO STEPS UP
C D E	D E F	E F G
C E D		
G G E		
E C D		

2 Write an answer ★★★

The question is C D E F | G. Write an answer of five notes that comes home to C.

[ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] C

3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

A motif is usually 2 to 6 notes.	T F
A question phrase ends on the home note.	T F
Most phrases are 4 bars long.	T F

4 In your music ★★☆

In a piece you play, pencil a curve over each phrase. How many phrases are there, and how long is each?

Phrases [ ] Bars in each [ ]

5 Play it ★☆☆

Play a piece and grow towards the high point of each phrase. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____